



» RANJI ROUND-UP

WHEN THE FEEDER BEGAN TO DRIFT FROM THE LINE

Flatter pitches, fractured schedules and confused pathways have left the Ranji Trophy increasingly **out of sync** with the demands of India's red-ball future.

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The Indian management's insistence on Test regulars plying their wares in the Ranji Trophy has lent some much-needed relevance to the country's premier First-Class tournament.

The marker was laid down last season when stalwarts Virat Kohli

(facing page, right) and Rohit Sharma were required to turn up for their domestic teams following their dismal run in the Border-Gavaskar Trophy, with Kohli managing 190 runs in five matches and Rohit just 31 in three. Shubman Gill, K.L. Rahul, and Ravindra Jadeja were among the others who returned to test

themselves in the attrition of four-day First-Class cricket though there were no immediate Test matches at that time.

However, the spotlight has been away from the Ranji Trophy this season, courtesy of a packed international calendar. Back-to-back Test series against West Indies and